TOWN OF THUNDERBOLT
REGULAR MONTHLY MEETING
WEDNESDAY, APRIL 13, 2022
6:30 PM

REGULAR MEETING

1. **Call to order:** Mayor Dana Williams has begun the meeting

2. **Roll Call by Presiding Officer with Invocation, followed by the Pledge of Allegiance**
   - Prayer was led by Councilman James Lavin

3. **Approval of Meeting Agenda**
   - Councilman Ward approves
   - Councilman Crenshaw seconds
   - Motion is approved

4. **Approval of Minutes from Previous Meeting**:
   Minutes of March 9, 2022
   - Councilman Ward motions to approve
   - Councilman Crenshaw seconds the motion to approve
   - Motion is approved

5. **Presentations:**

   - **Proclamation for Lemonade Day:** Mayor Dana Williams reads
     1. The Lemonade Day Program is a non-profit dedicated to teaching children how to run businesses and give back to the community.
     2. This program is directed towards children primarily from 3rd-5th grade.
     3. Kids will open a lemonade stand in the community.
     4. A portion of their profits will be donated to the charity of their choice.
     5. This will take place May 7th
     6. Purchase a cup of lemonade from any of these kids to help a worthy cause.
     7. Katina Spaulding has taken picture for proclamation documentation

   - **Proclamation for Sexual Assault Awareness:** Mayor Dana Williams reads
     1. Sexual Assault Awareness Month: April 2022
     2. Works to support victims in the court system as well as outside of it.
     3. Mary's Place - service 7 counties around the Savannah area.
     4. 24/7 services in person or on the phone.
     5. They also have bilingual employees to help hispanic citizens.

   - **Finance Report:**

1. **Monthly Financials**
    1. Shannon Brett
    2. Currently we are on target for the 1st quarter budget
        1. 31% of revenues for 1st Quarter
        2. 22% of expenses for 1st Quarter
    3. No questions from council
2. **2021 Balance Budget Amendment**
    1. Deducted the ARPA money
    2. $340,000 is going into capital reserves
    3. Storm shutters showed high which shows revenue increase
    4. In Water & Sewer there is a negative.
        1. This is the first year we have shown depreciation values. The total is over $80,000 to reserves.
    5. Dr. Drohan notes by fulfilling those reserves we will be able to maintain a steady price level in the future.
    6. Councilman Crenshaw motions to approve
    7. Councilman Drohan seconds
    8. Motion is approved unanimously.
3. **Procurement Policy**
    1. Milie wants to table conversation for next month as the audit may necessitate changes
    2. Motion is initiated by Councilman Crenshaw
    3. Motion is seconded by Councilman Ward
    4. Motion is approved unanimously.
4. **Update on Audit** (Added)
    1. Financial statement audit that will lead to the annual report. Monica is taking the lead collecting all required materials. They are leaning on Katina and Bob for supplemental information. We should have it ready by next month.
    2. Councilman Crenshaw: In the proposal Crenshaw wanted to replace a staff position, if it is possible could we have one person from your CPA staff to fill in to answer phones if they need a sub?
        1. They are team players, but that specifically is out of their scope.
        2. Councilman notes it would be a rare occurrence but understands.

6. **Consent Agenda:**

- **Approval of Home Occupation Permit for Bulldog Lighting and Events at 3005 River Dr. #312**
    1. Attorney Barrow wants to note the type of company Bulldog Lighting is.
    2. Secretary of State said this company ceased to exist in 2018.
    3. Mr. Milie wants to still vote on this matter
    4. Councilman Drohan motions to table this approval
    5. Councilman Ward motions to second the approval
    6. The motion is approved unanimously.

- **Outdoor Event Permit and Waiver for Parent University Fundraiser (April 23, 2022)**
    1. What is Parent University?
        1. A non-profit that provides training for parents who are struggling with parenting
    2. Where is the event going to take place?
        1. Most of it will be taking place on Savannah State's Campus
    3. So is this a 5k?
        1. Yes
    4. Will there be any road closures?
        1. No.

5. But they are running?
    1. Vehicles will just need to be aware of the runners
6. Councilman Crenshaw notes Savannah State Police will be monitoring the event.
7. Mr. Milie notes only 1/3rd of the race will actually be in Thunderbolt
8. Falligant to Bannon; Bannon to George; George to College and back
9. What time?
    1. 7am-10:30am

- **Outdoor Event Permit and Waiver for Thunderbolt Museum (continuous starting April 30, 2022)**
    1. Anna Marie with the Thunderbolt Museum
    2. Bizarre April 30th
    3. 25 vendors
    4. $25 to rent a vendor space
    5. museum is now open Wed-Thurs from 10-2 nd Sat from 10-3
    6. Pop up shop on the inside with things we are going to sell in the garage sale

- **Approval of the Right of Way Permit**
    1. Beth Goette- 600 Leonard st
        1. Has question on Right of Way Permit. What is it?
            1. Mr. Milie: This is for private companies who are going to do work on roads in thunderbolt.
            2. The companies must give advanced notice, adhere to state requirements,if they cannot have flaggers, must go through the police department
            3. Creates a process for people who want to close the road to have to give advanced notice.
            4. This is just a general policy going forward.
        2. Will there be a fee?
            1. Yes.
        3. What is the fee?
            1. $65 application fee
            2. Other fees will apply for closures and special circumstances
        4. Will there be a notification to residents
            1. We certainly can give notice if this motion will pass for all closures
            2. We can add a modification saying the private company must notice residents before all closures

- Councilman Crenshaw motions to approve Items B,C, and D and to table A.
- Councilman Ward Seconds
- Motion is approved unanimously.

7. **Discussion Agenda**

- **Approval of the Holland, Bromley, Barnhill & Brett Agreement**
    1. Mr. Milie invites Shannon Brett for questions
    2. Do we have any Fire Subscription Fees?
        1. We are in a service delivery strategy now to drop the other side of SSU and retain Slyvan where we do not have to provide service to the SSU area.
    3. The relative costs having this contract versus having a full time employee
        1. $64,000 starting salary
        2. Plus adding all of the benefits and workers comp, social security, their salary would be almost $90,000
        3. The opposite is a savings about $30,000
        4. Removing this position saves money Councilman Ward notes.
    4. Councilman Ward motions to approve the motion

5. Councilman Crenshaw seconds the motion
6. Councilman Lavin: We get everything we need with the CPA company rather than the full time employee
7. Councilman Crenshaw: The audits always direct the auditors to look at the payables including the vendors. For the vendors that had an email and address in the form of a P.O. Box it is generally a red flag. This should be handled outside of internal staff.
8. Finances are now so important we have an outsider who is looking at the books.
9. Shannon Brett made note and will request a review by the auditor.
10. Motion is approved unanimously.

- **Approval of the Revise Website Contract**
  1. Only approving if all parts of this contract as is are good.
  2. Mayor Dana Williams notes the extreme excitement of the town for this new website. We are currently having a lot of issues with the current website, including minutes being posted.
  3. Councilman Drohan wants to approve it tonight and tabling this does not seem appropriate.
  4. Pricing is about the same with a $2000 savings
  5. Councilman Crenshaw notes Item 13 reads suppose we cancel before the year is up will we have to pay for the whole year?
     1. We would have already paid for the whole year in advance. It is not a large sum to lose.
     2. Councilman Crenshaw wants to tinker with it so that it reads the amount owed should be prorated at the time it is canceled.
  6. Mayor Williams asks for a motion
  7. Councilman Crenshaw motions to approve
  8. Councilman Drohan motions to second
  9. Councilman Skipper notes the work section will also need to be prorated
  10. Danny Goette- Having issues with hearing people (Mics were adjusted)
  11. Motion is approved unanimously.

- **Approval of the Granicus Short Term Rental Host Compliance Contract**
  1. An agreement for Granicus Short Term Rental Host Compliance Contract
  2. Revised based on Attorney Barrow's suggestions
  3. The pricing proposal will be included if approved
  4. Attorney Barrow notes there is not an Exhibit A
  5. Councilman Ward proposes a motion to approve contract
  6. Councilman Crenshaw seconds
  7. Motion is approved. Councilman Bethany Skipper and Councilman Drohan have abstained from voting.

8. **Town Administrator Report:** Town Administrator, Bob Milie
   - We are moving forward with LMIG to redo Rowland Drive.
   - We are still waiting on the grant for the county to service the senior center but made it to the second round
     1. The grant would cover the day to day costs
   - Blessing of the Fleet
     1. GOAL: Raise $35,000 by March 5th but only at $20,000 right now
     2. People didn't want to pay just for a month of advertising
     3. There has been a modification for sponsorships for a full year
     4. Mr. Milie thinks the money will come in but needs a vote to continue with this funding initiative
     5. We will scale down to not affect townspeople
     6. Councilman Crenshaw motions to approves
     7. Councilman Ward seconds the motion

8. Councilman Drohan wants clarification
    1. Mr. Milie: Yes, They will get a year's worth of advertising.
9. Councilman Skipper wants to know what we will need to scale back to?
    1. We may not need to do any cuts if we can get donations. If we do have to do any cuts would be on signage
10. Councilman Crenshaw notes if we aren't on track we will need to scale back.
11. Mr. Milie feels comfortable to proceed as is for the moment.
12. Motion is approved unanimously.

9. **Department Report** – Written Reports Submitted

by: **Police / Municipal Court / Neighborhood Watch – Sean Clayton, Chief of Police**

- Mr. Milie: The mayor called the other day and noted there was an individual walking across the bridge heading towards the islands. The Thunderbolt police were called and they came right away. The officer that responded talked the individual down and drove them home. Kudos to you guys. You are doing an amazing job.

Fire –Fire Chief, Andrew Bateman

- Andrew Bateman is not present today
- No Questions

Public Works Department – Oscar Crosby, Public Works Manager

- Kudos on the park development. They are picking it up and making the town look great!
- Fluoride is fine
- Chris Rang
    - What's going on with the road closure near Tubbys?
        - Mayor Dana Williams: We will address.

10. **Road Closure:**
    - Chris Rang: What's going on with the road closure near Tubbys?
    - Mayor Dana Williams: We will address.
        1. There were many complaints of exsessive speeding. PD put a sign out that tracked speeders and number of vehicles.
        2. We started trying different experiments to slow the traffic down.
        3. The first night the police set up camp by Tubby's and wrote 98 speeding tickets.
        4. We first tried to slow the vehicles with speed bumps. This was not effective.
        5. The first night we did the barricade as a temporary test.
        6. So far this has greatly slowed down the traffic.
        7. We don't have the budget to hire more police officers.
        8. We encourage feedback from the citizens.

11. **Legal Report – Town Attorney**
    - First Reading of the Sewage Ordinance Modification
        1. It changes the compliance enforcement from us to the City of Savannah. They will be in charge of enforcing the sewage ordinances.
        2. It is only a one sentence change that should be approved in next month's council meeting.
        3. Councilman Crenshaw wants to know how they will enforce it?
            1. Oscar:
                1. They will do bi-weekly tests at the main lift station then consult our public works department.
                2. Check manifests.
                3. They will have to work with our public works for blockages.
                4. We will adopt the City of Savannah City Ordinance
            2. Will Fine enforcement come through the Town of Thunderbolt?

1. Yes but they will have to work with Savannah City Legal counsel when issues arise

- First Reading of the Short Term Rental Sign Requirements
    1. Attorney Barrow opens for discussion
    2. Councilman Crenshaw notes the size of the sign may become an issue. If it is too big it cannot be posted properly. In favor of a sign as long as it is small.
    3. Signage will include address and emergency contact name and phone. (for the police and fire department)
    4. Councilman Crenshaw proposes Council approves signs before they are posted for discretion.
    5. Personal Information is being listed. This may present a problem for the agent in charge.
    6. Councilman Barbaree: What if they had a QR code on a mailbox with that information instead of a sign in order to protect their privacy?
    7. Councilman Lavin notes if there is nothing it will not help.
    8. Mayor Dana Williams wants to know if we will enact this with long term rentals?
        1. Mr. Milie: It can only be rentals that are less than 30 days.
    9. Mayor Dana proposes to take out the name but to still have the phone number. It is possible to list just the word "Owner".
    10. Whatever is in this ordinance is only a minimum
    11. Councilman Drohan: 3319 Bannon Drive: is now speaking as a citizen and will be for the remainder of this discussion
    12. He has been involved for 2 years in this issue of STR. The only concern people had was with the size of the sign.
    13. From a public safety standpoint the signs are not dangerous. The issue is the ability to get in touch with the landlords when problems arise.
    14. Right now we only have 34 STR requests. Only half have been approved. The signs are big and ugly and the idea of sharing things with neighbors wouldn't be a problem.
    15. Mr. Milie asks clarification
        1. No sign, just neighbor notifications
        2. It would be fine to have the information on the website.
    16. It will be about two months for the website to be completed.
    17. Councilman Crenshaw suggests lawyer have a discretionary clause or just reduce the size of the sign.
    18. Attorney Barrow will draft three options.

12. **Mayor and Council –**
    - Water & Sewer Committee – Council Member Drohan
        1. Mayor Dana Williams
            1. Event Information for the Easter Egg Hunt
                1. This Saturday at Cesaroni Field 11am-2pm
                2. Open to the public
                3. Bring your kids and have a ball!
            2. The onions are ready.
        2. Councilman Drohan
            1. Last month he proposed whether they would be interested in a Conservation Committee. 11 people have shared an interest.
            2. There was a short meeting just before this councilman.
            3. If anyone else has an interest please contact him.
            4. Wants to revisit the budgeting issue with water and sewer
                1. He wants to overcome lethargy when it comes to terms with water and sewage.
                2. With this adjustment we can get the problems addressed in a timely fashion.

13. **Executive Session-** Mayor requests a motion and a second to recess into executive session for the purpose of Legal, Real Estate and/or Personnel matters.
    - Councilman Ward motions to Adjourn to Executive Session
    - Councilman Crenshaw Seconds
    - The Motion is approved.

14. **Adjournment: Mayor Dana Williams Proposes a Need to Motion back into Regular Session**
    - Councilman Ward motions to return
    - Councilman Skipper seconds
    - Motion is approved unanimously.
    - No further business Mayor seeks a motion to adjourn.
    - Councilman Crenshaw motions to adjourn
    - Councilman Ward seconds
    - Motion is approved unanimously.

Mayor, Dana Williams

Clerk of Council, Deatre N. Denion